

Chapter 165-4

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When it comes to matters of the heart, it's like a fish drinking water—only it knows whether the water is cold or warm.¹

No one can make decisions for someone else.

Even though Xu Qingzhu had channeled her top-student spirit, reading many books and watching many dramas to thoroughly research the topic of relationships—even flipping through several psychology books specifically to understand intimate relationships—

She could only understand other people's feelings.

When it came to herself, she could only sit numbly and wait for her fate.

And occasionally resort to some underhanded means.

Liang Shi was quite emotional about it. She later summarized to Xu Qingzhu that this was probably a characteristic of actors—always being swept up in other people's emotions.

But she was also powerless to change it.

However, after Liang Shi returned to Xu Qingzhu's side, Xu Qingzhu's physical condition was good. Liang Shi accompanied Xu Qingzhu to the hospital for a follow-up examination, and the ultrasound the doctor took showed—it was a pair of twins.

At that moment, Liang Shi didn't even have time to bask in the joy of having twins. Instead, she was thinking—did this mean she had successfully exploited the bug?

Just as she was thinking this, that strange mechanical voice suddenly appeared: 【Do you really think our algorithm is that bad? The laws of every plane world have been tested and calculated multiple times. How could you possibly exploit a bug?】

Liang Shi: "..."

Then Liang Shi realized that even if she had exploited a bug, it would only have worked after a real divorce. But she had torn up that divorce agreement and thrown it in the trash after coming home.

So if this wasn't a bug, then who bore the damage?

System: 【Xu Qingzhu. Lu Jiayi also bore part of it.】

Liang Shi: "..."

"So it's all resolved now?" Liang Shi asked.

System: 【Yes. After this major node concluded, all events have been rewritten.】

Liang Shi understood it as facing a fork in the road—one path would be dangerous, while the other was absolutely safe, the destined path.

The pain was only in those first few steps and the process of making the choice. After that, there would be no more.

Just as Liang Shi was thinking, the system's voice rang out again, sounding smug: 【Oh right, according to calculations, the computational laws of the plane world were already rewritten twenty days ago. The balance laws have been corrected.】

Liang Shi: "?"

Twenty days ago—doing a quick calculation, that was the day she left the divorce agreement.

Going back further, it was actually when Xu Qingzhu raised the knife toward her, then ultimately defied the world's will and turned the blade on herself.

The system said exploiting bugs was impossible, so it had to be the latter.

The decision Xu Qingzhu made in that moment, defying the world's will—their children had almost not been saved either.

Liang Shi felt that the balance laws of the plane world probably weren't satisfied with just Xu Qingzhu and Lu Jiayi being injured. These two babies must have also borne part of it.

Personal will defying the world's will.

Just thinking about it seemed impossible.

But Xu Qingzhu was someone who excelled at creating miracles.

And she had actually done it.

Liang Shi suddenly remembered that phrase—*I will defy my instincts to continue loving you.*

This emotion made her whole heart ache and swell. She really wanted to go and hug her.

But the system's next words pulled her right back: 【Host, how is your evidence collection going?】

Liang Shi: "..."

【The original body is being well preserved in an interstellar ice coffin, while the soul is imprisoned in an interstellar prison. A harm level assessment was just conducted, and she still registers at 3S danger level. Under these circumstances, do you still want to file an appeal for her?】

Liang Shi nodded. "Yes."

System: 【Then you need to collect evidence as soon as possible. We will continue to monitor the original body's danger level. However, the good news is that the original body's harmful consciousness has somewhat weakened. There is hope that it will drop to 2S level within a month.】

Liang Shi commented, "That's pretty good."

System: 【...】

The system had nothing to say and went silent.

But the system's appearance left Liang Shi speechless for quite a while. She had tried so hard to exploit a bug, all for nothing.

She was so annoyed that she skipped dinner that day.

But she woke up in the middle of the night and ordered takeout with Xu Qingzhu.

The two of them ate while watching TV. When they finished, Xu Qingzhu casually asked, "When is your drama airing?"

Liang Shi shook her head. "I don't know."

The one most likely to air now was "Mo Xin".

Films aiming for awards usually got approved relatively quickly.

Liang Shi sent a message to ask Gu Yixue, and at four in the morning, Gu Yixue replied with a voice message: "Probably spring."

Less than half a year—that was indeed quite fast.

By the time Liang Shi saw Gu Yixue's message, it was already nine in the morning, and she needed to drive Xu Qingzhu to the company.

Gu Yixue's voice in the recording sounded somewhat dry and hoarse, like she had just finished smoking.

Liang Shi asked with concern: 【Are you abroad on your honeymoon? Why aren't you asleep at that hour?】

Gu Yixue replied instantly: 【I am abroad, but it's just me.】

Liang Shi: 【?】

In the voice message Gu Yixue sent, she was even laughing: "I'm here for a film festival. Shen Fenghe is still in the country. How could we possibly have a honeymoon?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Every single one of them was a handful.

Even without any dramas airing, her agent was still actively finding work for Liang Shi.

Having discovered such shocking gossip in the office before, the agent remained unflappable on the surface no matter how shocked she was internally, and she kept her mouth tightly shut.

She even treated Liang Shi the same way as before, without a hint of flattery.

But it was true that she was more lenient with her now. She didn't keep piling work on her like before, and only contacted her again after she had rested for so many days.

"Are you free tomorrow?" Chang Hui asked directly. "There's a casting director for a variety show who wants to meet you. Shall we meet at 10 AM tomorrow at the company café?"

Liang Shi agreed.

Although she preferred acting in dramas over participating in variety shows, she could understand her agent's good intentions. Artists needed to maintain exposure during days when they weren't filming, and acting on variety shows was actually the hardest.

You were clearly acting, but you couldn't let people see through it.

So when it came to decent variety shows, she would participate.

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1. "如魚飲水，冷暖自知" (rú yú yǐn shuǐ, lěng nuǎn zì zhī): A Chinese idiom meaning "like a fish drinking water, only it knows whether it's cold or warm." It expresses that only the person involved truly understands their own situation or feelings. ⇐